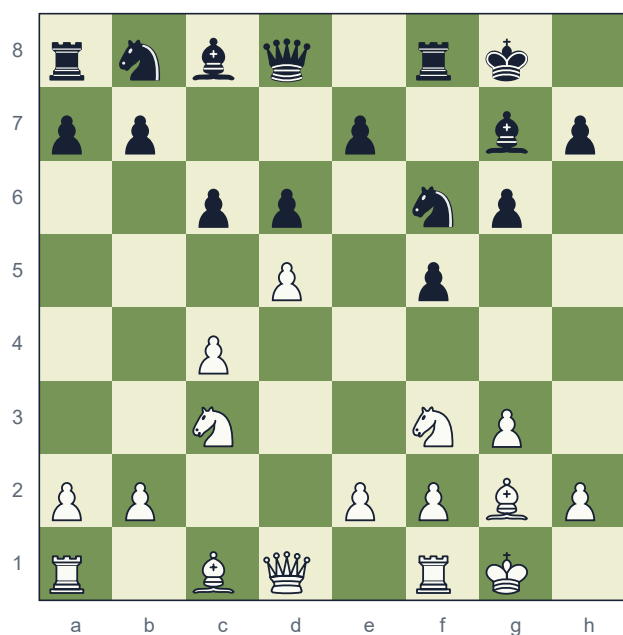


Dutch Defense: defer c4 with 2.g3

1.d4 f5 2.g3

YOUR REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Choose a fianchetto against the Dutch and add c4 after your king is ready. This is a move-order preference; 2.c4 is also a sound move.



Main-line anchor - Black to move

THE PAWN STRUCTURE

The f5 pawn controls e4 but weakens the king and e6/e5 complex. Black's choice of ...g6, ...e6/...d5, or ...e6/...d6 creates three different structures.

WHAT BLACK WANTS

The Leningrad uses a kingside fianchetto; the Stonewall locks d5-e6-f5; the Classical keeps ...d6 and seeks ...e5 or a kingside initiative.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Do not play the same middlegame plan against all Dutch structures.
2. e5 is a key square in the Stonewall; ...e5 is a key freeing break in other Dutch systems.
3. Trade or restrain attacking pieces before opening your king with pawn moves.

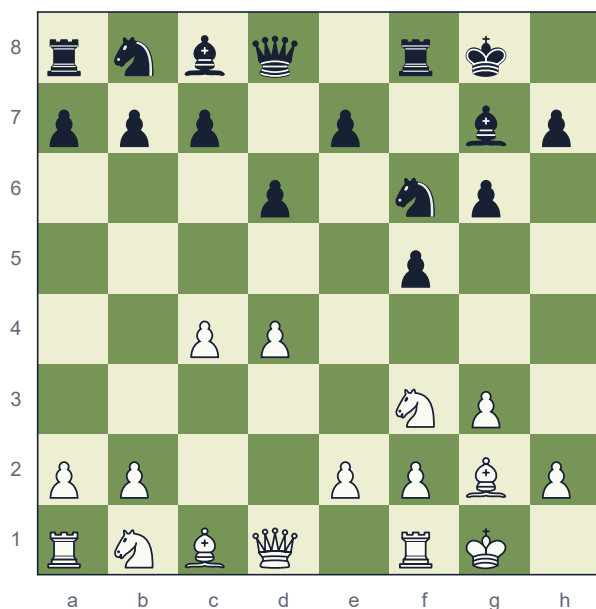
Line pages contain a selected opening anchor plus an illustrative checked continuation. They are not a forced script. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Leningrad Dutch

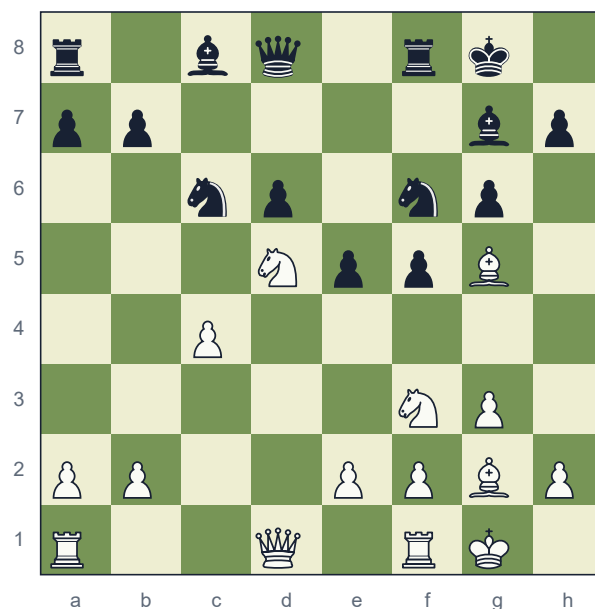
STUDY LINE 19-01

1. d4 f5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. O-O O-O 6. c4 d6 7. Nc3 c6 8. d5 cxd5 9. Nxd5 e5 10. Bg5 Nc6

Selected anchor ends with 8. d5. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White castles before confronting the center. d5 gains space and asks how Black will organize ...e5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Keep central control and watch ...Qe8 or ...Na6. A timely e4 can be strong, but its tactical support must be real.

WATCH FOR

The black f-pawn has already moved; opening the center may expose either king depending on development.

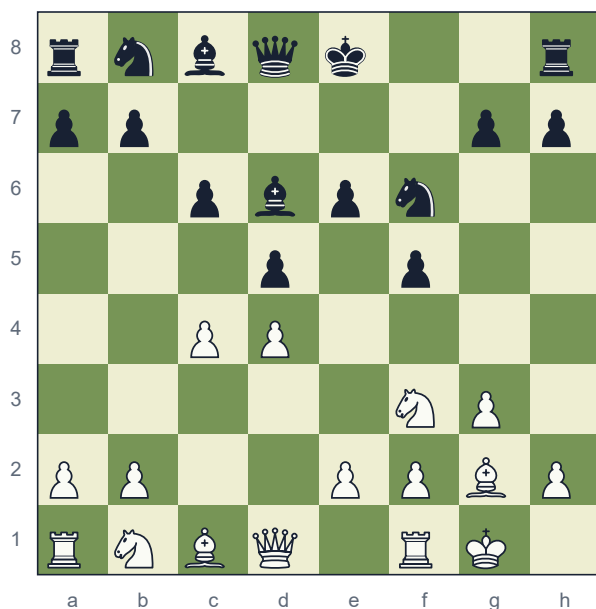
REMEMBER A secure king makes the central confrontation easier.

02 Stonewall and the Ba3 idea

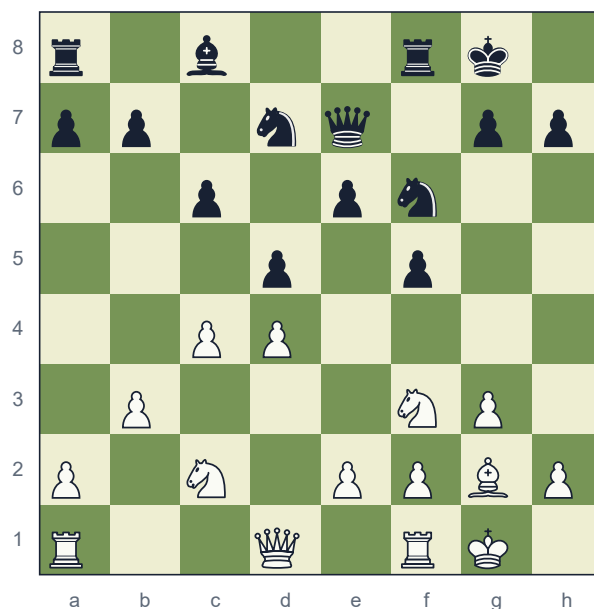
STUDY LINE 19-02

1. d4 f5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. Nf3 d5 5. O-O Bd6 6. c4 c6 7. b3 O-O 8. Ba3 Bxa3 9. Nxa3 Qe7 10. Nc2 Nbd7

Selected anchor ends with 9. Nxa3. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Ba3 challenges the good d6 bishop. The knight recapture develops a piece that may head toward c2 and e5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Use e5 as an outpost and improve the remaining bishop. Keep ...Ne4 and ...g5 under observation.

WATCH FOR

Do not put a knight on e5 if exchanging it would strengthen Black's attack or create a protected passed pawn.

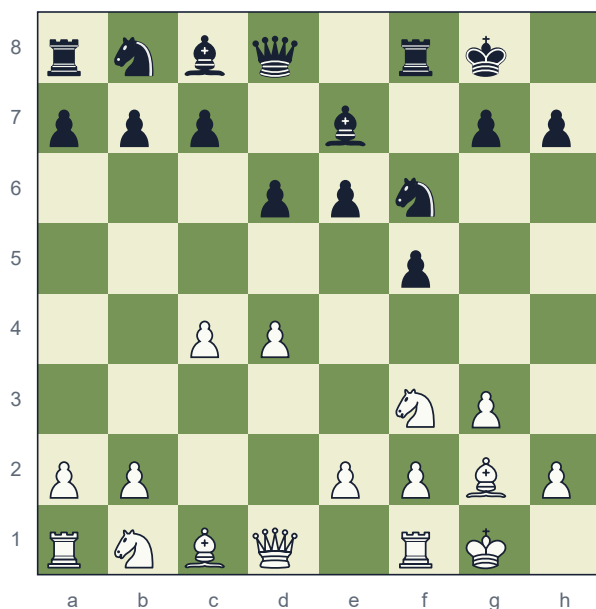
REMEMBER Exchange the good bishop and contest e5.

03 Classical Dutch

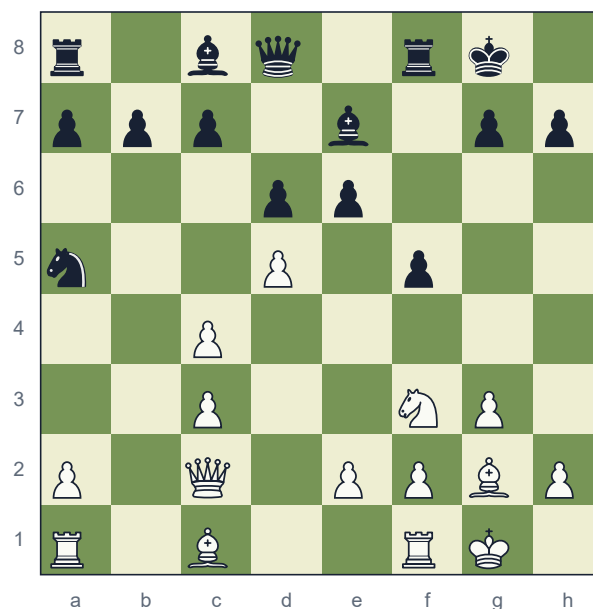
STUDY LINE 19-03

1. d4 f5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. Nf3 Be7 5. O-O O-O 6. c4 d6 7. Nc3 Ne4 8. Qc2 Nxc3 9. bxc3 Nc6 10. d5 Na5

Selected anchor ends with 8. Qc2. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Qc2 supports central play and questions the advanced knight. Black has a flexible center rather than a Stonewall.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Prepare e4 or improve the queen bishop. Meet kingside activity by acting in the center when it is sound.

WATCH FOR

Do not allow ...Nxc3 to damage your structure without considering the recapture and long diagonal.

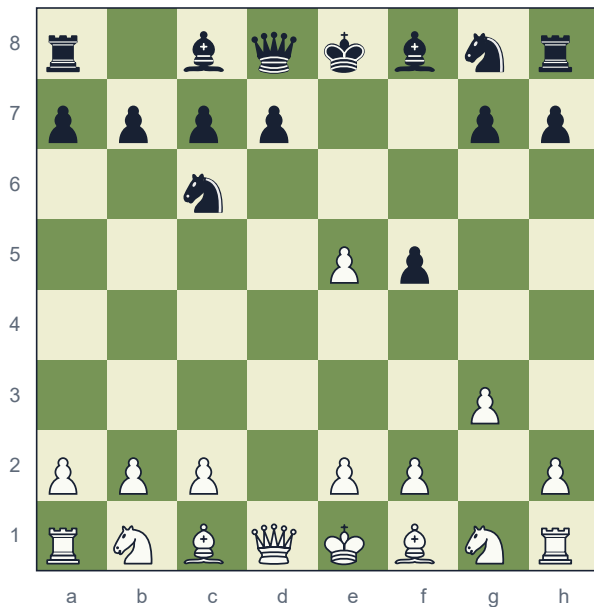
REMEMBER Use central play against a flank initiative.

04 Black tries an early ...e5

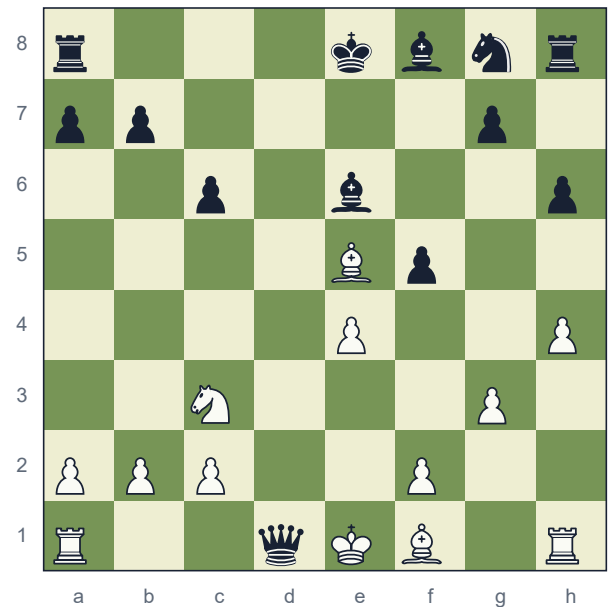
STUDY LINE 19-04

1. d4 f5 2. g3 e5 3. dxe5 Nc6 4. Nf3 d6 5. Bf4 h6 6. h4 Be6 7. Nc3 dxe5 8. Nxe5 Nxe5 9. Bxe5 c6 10. e4 Qxd1+

Selected anchor ends with 4. Nf3. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 3 - White to move



End of study line - White to move - in check

WHY THESE MOVES

Accept the pawn and develop. Black's f-pawn move changes the central and king-safety calculation from an Englund Gambit.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

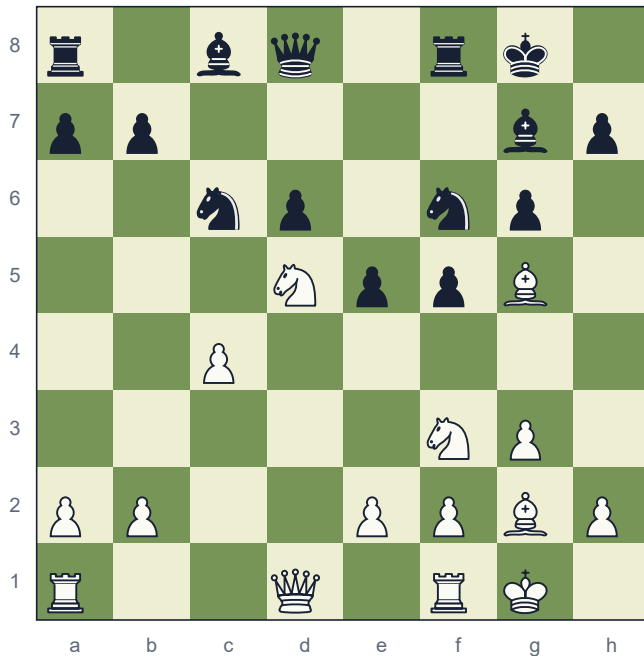
First answer the check shown in the final diagram. Bg2 and castling are the aims. Return a pawn if necessary to finish development and neutralize threats.

WATCH FOR

Do not spend tempi defending e5 with a chain of pawn moves while Black mobilizes.

REMEMBER Against an early gambit, development is your insurance.

Review before your next game



Main-line study position - White to move

1. IDENTIFY THE STRUCTURE.

The f5 pawn controls e4 but weakens the king and e6/e5 complex. Black's choice of ...g6, ...e6/...d5, or ...e6/...d6 creates three different structures.

2. NAME BLACK'S PLAN.

The Leningrad uses a kingside fianchetto; the Stonewall locks d5-e6-f5; the Classical keeps ...d6 and seeks ...e5 or a kingside initiative.

3. CHOOSE YOUR NEXT JOB.

Keep central control and watch ...Qe8 or ...Na6. A timely e4 can be strong, but its tactical support must be real.

RECONSTRUCTION DRILL

Set up the starting position and play the main study line without looking. After each Black move, say what changed. If you cannot explain your reply, stop at that position and review the relevant line page.

DECISION DRILL

Return to the diagram. Write two candidate moves and a likely reply to each. You are not trying to guess the next engine move: you are testing whether your choices fit the structure and survive checks, captures and threats.

SELF-CHECK

Can you identify every capture and recapture in the line? Can you state one move-order exception? Can you explain the final position without using the opening name?

Related practice: Booklet 24. Use the matching line ID in the PGN companion. Opening names: Lichess public opening dataset; original course choices and analysis, checked with Stockfish 18.